



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

You're a philatelist? What's that?



## Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- Have you ever collected stamps?
- Would you like to collect stamps? Why or why not?

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about hobbies.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about general and specific quantities.





## Let's Explore!

In her newest article, Sally talks about stamp collecting.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

A few letters have arrived in the mail. You have begun a stamp collection! Philately is a very popular hobby. There is no lack of philatelists who collect and trade every type of stamp. There are plenty of ways to obtain stamps, including buying them at stamp conventions, through stamp clubs, on the Internet, or trading with friends.

Official postage stamps began in Great Britain in the 1800s. Several stamps were issued with pictures of Queen Victoria. Since then, the range of images has grown. Each year, thousands of stamps are dedicated to special events, such as the Olympics, national celebrations, and other historical occasions.

Stamp collecting is a flexible hobby. Some collectors prefer to collect stamps from specific countries or on a certain theme, such as flowers, maps or birds. Even with limited free time and money, a person can start to gather stamps and join the millions of other people who eagerly wait for their mail to arrive every day.

**Let's Practice!**

Nowadays, stamps have images of national celebrations and historical occasions.

*Instructions: Select all the correct answers.*

1. Select the sentences in the Present Perfect tense.
  - a. A few letters have arrived in the mail.
  - b. You have begun a stamp collection!
  - c. Philatelists have plenty of ways to obtain stamps.
  - d. Several stamps have been issued with pictures of the Queen.
  - e. Each year, thousands of stamps are dedicated to special events.
  
2. Select the sentences in the Simple Past tense
  - a. Official postage stamps began in Great Britain in the 1800s.
  - b. Several stamps were issued with pictures of historical occasions.
  - c. Since then, the range of images has grown.
  - d. Even with limited free time and money, a person can start to gather stamps.
  - e. I waited for the mail.

**Let's Practice!**

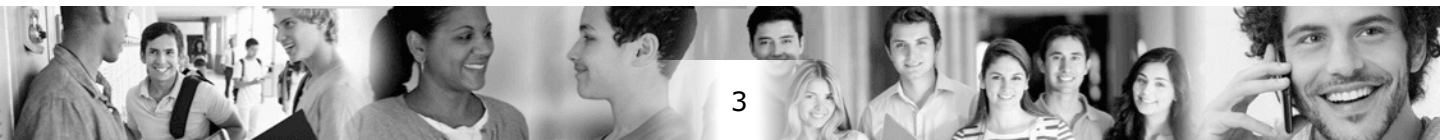
Would you like to be a philatelist?

*Instructions: Complete the sentence below by choosing one of the options given.*

**Word Bank**

celebrations / Philatelists / events / stamp /  
occasions / Olympics / Philately / themes

1. \_\_\_\_\_ is a very popular hobby.
2. \_\_\_\_\_ collect and trade every type of \_\_\_\_\_.
3. The range of \_\_\_\_\_ has grown to include special \_\_\_\_\_ ,  
such as the \_\_\_\_\_ , national \_\_\_\_\_ , and other historial  
\_\_\_\_\_ .





## Extension Activity

Design a stamp for a special occasion and explain why it is important.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Choose a special occasion. It can be something in your personal life or something everyone knows about.
- Make a sketch of the event. Make it look like it is on a stamp.
- Write a paragraph explaining why this is an important event for you.
- Read your paragraph to a partner.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I choose a special occasion.

☐ ☐

I design a stamp.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph of 60 - 80 words.

☐ ☐

I read the paragraph aloud.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **philately** (noun): the name of the activity of collecting stamps  
e.g. Philately is a very popular hobby.
- **philatelist** (noun): a person who collects stamps  
e.g. There is no lack of philatelists who collect and trade every type of stamp.
- **theme** (noun): something that different things have in common  
e.g. Some collectors prefer to collect stamps on a certain theme, such as flowers, maps or birds.
- **mail** (noun): documents delivered to your home  
e.g. Philatelists eagerly wait for their mail every day.
- **stamp** (noun): a small piece of paper placed on items sent in the mail as proof of payment  
e.g. You have the beginning of a stamp collection!





## Learning Points

### Present Perfect vs. Simple Past Tenses

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a finished action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** necessarily connected to the present.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience. When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

- *I have learned English* = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.
- *He has bought a painting* = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

We use **have/has + the past participle** of the verb in Present Perfect sentences.

Look at the chart about how to form the Present Perfect tense:

| Main Verb | Past Tense | Past Participle | Present Perfect Tense            |
|-----------|------------|-----------------|----------------------------------|
| arrive    | arrived    | arrived         | A few letters have arrived...    |
| grow      | grew       | grown           | The range of images has grown... |
| begin     | began      | begun           | You have begun...                |

### Examples:

- *A few letters have arrived in the mail. You have a stamp collection!*
- *Since the 1800s, the range of stamp images has grown.*





## Learning Points

### Quantifiers

You use a quantifier before a noun to indicate the amount or number of an item. Quantifiers do not indicate a specific quantity but rather a general amount.

- You use quantifiers with both count and non-count nouns.
- Quantifiers like *a few, several, many, dozens, hundreds, thousands, or millions*, can only be used with count nouns.
- You can use all of the quantifiers below with both count and non-count nouns.

| Quantifier            | Meaning                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| a couple              | two                                          |
| a few                 | around three or more                         |
| no/none               | 0, nothing                                   |
| any/not any           | ask about a number or amount/say there is no |
| some                  | a small, general number or amount            |
| a lot of/lots of/tons | a very large number or amount                |
| plenty of             | more than you need                           |
| lack of               | less than you need                           |

### Examples:

- *Any time a few letters arrive in the mail, you have the beginning of a stamp collection.*
- *There is no lack of philatelists who collect and trade every type of stamp.*

